May 2026

DR. STEPHANIE SANTSCHI

サンチ・ステファニー

Japanese visual culture / digital art history / AI in higher education

Current position	Postdoctoral Fellow at the Chair of East Asian Art History
Affiliation	University of Zurich (UZH), Department of Art History, Chair of East Asian Art History, Rämistrasse 73, CH-8006 Zurich, Switzerland
Email	stephanie.santschi@khist.uzh.ch
Online	LinkedIn | UZH Profile | DSI Profile
Languages	German (native), English (fluent), Japanese (modern: fluent; classical: reading), French (fluent), Italian (basic), Latin (reading knowledge)



EDUCATION

University of Zurich (UZH) | Doctorate, Summa cum Laude: East Asian Art History 02/2018 – 02/2023
Dissertation: *"Visual Vocabularies Within Poetic Microcosms: How Hokusai's Social Embedding Shaped Content and Presentation of the 'Ono' and 'Ryakuga' Manuals."* Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Hans B. Thomsen and Prof. Dr. Julie Nelson Davis (University of Pennsylvania) Conferred 30/05/2023

- UZH Travel Scholarship, Conference Attendance and Fieldwork (JP) 07/2023
- Eighth Graduate Summer School in Japanese Early-modern Palaeography, Cambridge (UK) 08/2022
- Toshiba Foundation Fellow, Dissertation Research, Yokohama (JP) 06–08/2020
- Nippon Foundation Fellow, Advanced Japanese, Stanford IUC, Yokohama (JP) 09/2019 – 06/2020

University of East Anglia (UK) | MA with Distinction: Museum Studies 09/2015 – 12/2016
Master Thesis: *"A collector's story in the making: how Edmond Michotte's personal contribution to Belgian Japonisme influences the perception of his legacy."* Conf. 02/12/2016

- Kadokawa Summer School "Animating Life," University of Tokyo (JP) 07/2016

UZH | BA: East Asian Art History, Japanese Studies, Education 2010 – 2015
Bachelor Thesis: *"Challenges of multilingualism within Japanese woodblock print exhibitions."* Conf. 31/07/2015

- Language Exchange Japanese, Doshisha University, Kyoto (JP) 03/2014 – 02/2015

RESEARCH PROJECTS (PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR)

Drawing from the Crowd: A Citizen Science Platform for Mapping *Ukiyo-e* Geography 2024 –
In collaboration with Smapshot, EPFL and ARC-iJAC, Ritsumeikan University
Citizen-science georeferencing of *ukiyo-e* landscape prints, integrating computer-vision methods (Vision-Language Models) for the analysis of spatial representation. Public launch late 2025; registered on SciStarter (international) and CoLabField (Japan).

- Implementation Funding: GRC Career Grant, UZH (CHF 13,300) 07/2025 – 06/2026
- Prototype Funding: The Nippon Foundation Scholars Association (ca. USD 15,000) 08/2024 – 01/2025

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AI_d: AI Didactic Companion for East Asian Art History 2025 –
Pedagogical chatbot framework grounded in Bloom's Taxonomy, SAMR, and Cognitive Apprenticeship; integrated with UZH learning platforms.

- Universitäre Lehrförderung (ULF), micro_innovation 2025 (CHF 4,000) 06/2025 –01/2026

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE *(in Switzerland unless stated)*

Postdoctoral Fellow, Chair of East Asian Art History, University of Zurich 03/2024 –
Research, teaching, and administrative coordination and support at the Chair (Prof. Dr. Ewa Machotka). Coordinator of Digital Humanities activities. PI on two third party-funded projects (see Research Projects above).

Guest Curator, Linden-Museum Stuttgart, Germany 09/2023 –
Research and publication on the Kurrus Collection of Edo and Meiji-period illustrated Japanese books (ca. 100) and single-sheet prints (ca. 900); planning of a digital exhibition module.

Cultural Promotion Officer, Cantonal Cultural Agency Grisons, Amt für Kultur 01/2023 – 02/2024
Employee, PortaCultura GR. Co-developed a cantonal cultural-heritage platform: data and content curation, interface conceptualisation, workshops, knowledge transfer.

Scientific Coordinator, Swiss Art Research Infrastructure (SARI), UZH 06/2020 – 12/2022
Project Coordinator, Bilder der Schweiz Online (BSO). Semantic-web infrastructure for cultural data; data-supported geo-localisation of ca. 28,000 Swiss prints, drawings, and photographs (1700–1950) in collaboration with Smapshot/EPFL; knowledge transfer to project partners.

Technical Research Assistant, The British Museum, London (UK) 10/2016 – 06/2019
Project: Late Hokusai: Thought, Technique, Society (10/2016 – 06/2019). Conceptualisation and development of a linked-data research and publication platform; coaching of the team in its use; curatorial, object-handling, and research duties in the Japanese Section.

Museum Intern, Japanese Section, BM: William Gowland collection research-data digitisation. 10/2015 – 09/2016

Photography Assistant, ARC Ritsumeikan Digitization Project, Kyoto (JP) 01/2016
Digitisation of Japanese illustrated books at the Musées Royaux d'Art et d'Histoire, Brussels (BE), and at Maidstone Museum (UK).

Founder, Vice-President, Secretary, Völkerkundesammlung Burgdorf Society 03/2013 – 03/2015
Co-curator of several exhibitions at the Völkerkundesammlung Burgdorf (2014).

Museum Intern, Musée d'Art et d'Histoire, Cabinet d'arts graphiques, Geneva 03–09/2013
Digitisation of a collection of Japanese prints; exhibition planning.

Research & Teaching Assistant — UZH, East Asian Art History 2011 – 2014

- Archival research: Völkerkundesammlung Burgdorf (09/2012 – 03/2014)
- Archival research: Netsuke collection of a private collector (04/2012 – 09/2012)
- Archival research: P. Rieder Collection of Japanese woodblock prints (09/2011 – 07/2012)
- Teaching Assistant, e-learning seminar of virtual lectures (2012)

TEACHING

All teaching at the Chair of East Asian Art History, UZH. BA = Bachelor, MA = Master. If not specified: offered to both. HS = autumn semester, FS = spring semester. 1 ECTS = 30h of student work.

Courses

- Methods in Digital (Art) Curation: The Sigg Collection *(6 ECTS, cross-listed exercise course)* FS 2026
- BA Seminar: Narrative Layers: Unveiling and Rewriting East Asian Art *(6 ECTS, co-taught)* FS 2026
- Excursion: East Asian Art Collections in the UK *(3 ECTS, co-taught with Chair-holder)* FS 2026
- Introduction to East Asian Art History: Propaedeutics *(BA, 6 ECTS)* HS 2025
- BA Seminar: Iridescent Luxuries: Perspectives on Commodities as Art in East Asia *(6 ECTS, co-taught)* FS 2025
- Excursion: East Asian Art Collections in Geneva *(6 ECTS, co-taught with Chair)* FS 2025
- Topical Readings in East Asian Art History *(MA, examiner for course taught by Chair-holder)* HS 2024
- Introduction to East Asian Art History: Propaedeutics *(BA, 6 ECTS, sole instructor)* HS 2024
- Introduction to Japanese Art *(BA, 9 ECTS, co-taught with Chair-holder)* HS 2024
- KU–UZH Joint Workshop in East Asian Art History 2024 *(3 ECTS)* HS 2024

Supervision of Graduation-Level Student Papers

- "Kano female painter Kiyohara Yukinobu in comparison."
  MA Thesis B.M. Wachsmuth. Planned submission: 12/2026

- "Von bedrohlich zu 'cool': Der Wandel der Oni-Darstellung."
  BA Thesis A. Gygli (co-supervision with Daniela Tan, AOI Institute, UZH). Submitted 12/2025

Workshops

- NIHU DiHuCo-UZH Roundtable on DH curriculum development across Switzerland and Japan, UZH 03/2026
- "Developing Learning-Outcome-Oriented AI Usage Guidelines." AI in Teaching Forum, UZH. 08/2025
- "'Smapshot' and Snapshots: Project Presentation and Career Development Q&A."
  Nippon Foundation Fellows Workshop, Stanford IUC, Yokohama (JP). 02/2025
- Lecturer, Swiss-Kansai Student Exchange Program Alumni Society. 2019 –
- "The Late Hokusai knowledge graph on ResearchSpace." Late Hokusai research workshops,
  Freer/Sackler Galleries, Washington DC; Metropolitan Museum of Art, New York. 04/2018

Pedagogical Development and Programme Design

- Developed redesigned assessment structures and AI-use guidelines integrated into UZH learning platforms (publication forthcoming in *Teaching in Higher Education*, 2026).
- Conceptual development of the study-programme at the Chair of East Asian Art History (since 2024): translation of strategic research vision into teaching components (programme design, assessment redesign), guidelines writing, and team communication infrastructure.

AWARDS

- UZH FAN Award 2026
  Outstanding scientific achievement in humanities & social sciences (CHF 5,000) 02/2026

SCHOLARSHIPS AND GRANTS

- UZH Graduate Research Center Career Grant (CHF 13,300) 07/2025 – 06/2026
- UZH micro_innovation Grant, ULF (CHF 4,000) 2025
- The Nippon Foundation: Nippon Social Innovation Challenge (ca. USD 15,000) 08/2024 – 01/2025
- UZH Postgraduate Travel Scholarship (CHF 1,200) 10/2024
- UZH Postgraduate Travel Scholarship (CHF 1,400) 07/2023
- Toshiba International Foundation (JP), Summer Research Scholarship (JPY 500,000) 06–08/2020
- Nippon Foundation Fellows (JP) and IUC Alumni Scholarship (USA) (ca. USD 45,000) 09/2019 – 06/2020
- Japan Foundation & Toshiba International Foundation (EU) Travel Grant EAJRS (GBP 300) 09/2018
- Great Britain Sasakawa Foundation (UK), Postgraduate Studentship (GBP 10,000) 09/2015 – 08/2016
- UZH International Relations, Exchange Studentship, Japan (CHF 10,000) 03/2014 – 02/2015

CURATORIAL & EDITORIAL EXPERIENCE

- **Guest Curator:** Kurrus Collection (2023–2026), Linden-Museum Stuttgart: research and digital curation.
- **Editor:** Made in Japan (16/05 – 21/07/2024), Kunstmuseum Basel: editorial language assistance.
- **Project Manager:** Bilder der Schweiz Online / Images of Switzerland (2020–2022), University of Zurich: digital curation of data and research practices.
- **Co-Curator:** Renewal of the Kofun-period display cases, Mitsubishi Corporation Japanese Galleries (opened 09/2018), The British Museum, London.
- **Technical Research Assistant:** Hokusai: beyond the Great Wave (25/05 – 13/08/2017), The British Museum, London.
- **Collection Manager:** Looking Beyond: Conversations between John Berger and John Christie (07/05 – 27/11/2016), Sainsbury Centre for Visual Arts, Norwich (UK).
- **Co-Curator:** Japan Sammeln – Nihon o Yobiyoseru (22/11/2014 – 18/01/2015), Japan Information and Cultural Center JICC, Bern.
- **Co-Curator:** Entdeckerlust – Burgdorfer in Ostasien (16/10/2014 – 05/07/2015), Schloss Burgdorf.
- **Intern:** Le Geste Suspendu (10/10/2014 – 11/01/2015), Cabinet d'arts graphiques, MAH, Geneva.
- **Co-Curator:** Konnichiwa! (19/01 – 12/05/2013), Creaviva, Zentrum Paul Klee, Bern.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

- President (2024 –), Member (2010 –), and LinkedIn Group Founder (2023 –) — KIZUNA, Japan Exchange Alumni Association in Switzerland.
- Lecturer, Swiss-Kansai Student Exchange Program Alumni Society (2019 – 2025).

SOCIETY MEMBERSHIPS

- European Association for Asian Art and Archaeology (EAAA), Member (2025 –).
- Nihon kinsei bungaku kai 日本近世文学会 [Japanese Early Modern Literature Association], Member (2025 –).
- Association for Asian Studies (AAS), Member (2025 –).
- Kokusai Ukiyo-e Gakkai 国際浮世絵学会, Member and Presenter (2023 –).
- The Nippon Foundation Scholars Association (Great Britain Sasakawa Foundation and Nippon Foundation Alumni), Member (2021 –).
- European Association of Japanese Resource Specialists (EAJRS), Member (2017 –).

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed Articles

- [Under peer-review] "When Mountains Move: Decoding Spatial Practices in Ukiyo-e Through Participatory Geolocalization and Computer Vision." *Digital Studies / Le Champ Numérique* (submitted November 2025).
- [Under peer-review] co-authored with H. Panday. "Algorithmic failure as methodology for art history: Machine learning's mispredictions identify rich cases for the qualitative analysis of *ukiyo-e* prints." *Digital Humanities Quarterly*, Special Issue on AI in Research (submitted May 2026).
- "Think tasks, not tools: why AI policy in higher education needs constructive alignment." *Teaching in Higher Education*, 2026. https://doi.org/10.1080/13562517.2026.2671391.
- "Mapping Late Hokusai Research: Digitizing and Publishing Bilingual Research Data." *Digital Studies / Le Champ Numérique* 12, no. 1 (2022). https://doi.org/10.16995/dscn.8079.
- With D. Oldman and D. Tanase, "ResearchSpace Case Study on Sequencing Hokusai Print Impressions to Form a Human Curated Network of Knowledge." *International Journal for Digital Art History* 4 (2019): 5.29–5.45. https://doi.org/10.11588/dah.2019.4.72071.

Book Chapters

- "Travel and Famous Places: Movement and Imagination in Ukiyo-e Landscapes / Voyage et lieux célèbres: mouvement et imaginaire dans l'ukiyo-e au fil des paysages." In *Impressions du Japon / Impressions of Japan*, edited by Anne Deltour and Margaux Honegger, 174–181. Zurich: Scheidegger & Spiess; Vevey: Musée Jenisch, 2025.
- "Hokusai beyond the database: transforming digital archives into a complex collaborative research environment." In *Late Hokusai: Society, Thought, Technique, Legacy*, edited by Timothy Clark, 245–252. London: The British Museum, 2023. https://doi.org/10.5167/uzh-237020.
- "Digitally Supported Visualisations of Japanese Archaeology at the British Museum." In *EU Workshop Report Papers / Kansai University Graduate School of Letters, EU – Japan Studies Activity Report 2016*, 231–250. Osaka: Kansai University, 2017.
- "Entdeckerlust, faszinierende Holzschnitte und Japan sammeln" [Essay on the history of the Völkerkundesammlung Burgdorf]. In *Burgdorfer Jahrbuch* 2015. Burgdorf: Verein Burgdorfer Jahrbuch, 2014. Open Access PDF.
- With R. Gomez Morilla and B. Huber, "La collection d'estampes japonaises du Cabinet d'arts graphiques des Musées d'art et d'histoire de Genève / The Japanese Woodcuts in the Collection of Prints and Drawings of the Musées d'art et d'histoire in Geneva." In *Le geste suspendu. Estampes Kabuki du Cabinet d'arts graphiques*, edited by Christian Rümelin. Cologne: Wienand Verlag, 2014.

Reviews & Reports

- Book review: *Salon Culture in Japan: Making Art, 1750–1900*, edited by Akiko Yano (London: British Museum Press, 2024). *Silva Iaponicarum* 74 (January 2026): 78–82. https://doi.org/10.14746/sijp.2025.74.5.
- Report: "Review of the 125th International ARC Seminar (Dr Ellis Tinios) — Hokusai the Alchemist: an exploration of sources for his book illustration." *Art Research* 25. Kyoto: Art Research Center Ritsumeikan, August 2024. ISSN 2436-5408.

- Report: "Drawings by Hokusai and His Students at the Museum of Fine Arts, Boston." *SISJAC e-Bulletin*, July 2023.

Research Blog & Conference Proceedings

- With Drew Richardson, "From Print to Place: Creating an Integrative Geolocalization Workflow Using Citizen Scientists and Computer Vision AI." *Conference Proceedings for The Digital Orientalist*, 12 December 2025.
- "Think Tasks Not Tools: Teaching AI Literacy in East Asian Art History." Guest contribution to *The Digital Orientalist*, 9 September 2025.

PRESENTATIONS

2026

- "Drawing from the Crowd: Combining Citizen Science and Computer Vision to Study Historical Japanese Prints." SADiLaR Digital Humanities Colloquium, North-West University (ZA, virtual), 25/03/2026, by invitation.
- "Drawing from the Crowd" [poster]. Association for Asian Studies (AAS) Annual Conference, Vancouver (CA), 14/03/2026.
- Panelist, "Building Global Networks to Address the Challenges Facing Japan Studies." Nippon Foundation Roundtable, AAS 2026, Vancouver (CA), 13/03/2026, by invitation.
- "AI_d: A Pedagogical Framework for AI Use in Higher Education." Seminar AI, Japanology, and Education 「AI・日本学・教育」, National Museum of Japanese History (Rekihaku), Sakura (JP), 23/01/2026, by invitation.
- 「市民科学で読み解く浮世絵の空間表現」/ "Reading Spatial Representation in Ukiyo-e through Citizen Science." Keio Museum Commons, Keio University, Tokyo (JP), 22/01/2026, by invitation.
- Keynote Lecture: "Making Computational Boundaries Visible: AI as Critical Tool in Japanese Visual Studies and Pedagogy." Digital Approach to Literary Analysis 2025 (DALA2025), Chuo University (co-hosted by NII), Tokyo, 19/01/2025, by invitation.
- "Drawing from the Crowd Project Update." The Nippon Foundation Scholars Association Webinar, Tokyo (virtual), 13/01/2026.

2025

- "Making Boundaries Visible: AI as Critical Tool in Japanese Visual Studies." *From Mimesis to Machine: AI and the Evolution of Artistic Creation*, Istituto Svizzero, Rome (IT), 27/11/2025, by invitation.
- "Zwischen Parodie und Poetik: Die Text-Bild-Synthese in Katsushika Hokusais frühesten Malereihandbüchern (1810–1814)." *Interdisziplinäres Symposium: Die Kunst der Illustration*, SIK-ISEA, Zurich, 20/11/2025.
- "Moving Mountains: Analyzing Spatial Narratives in Ukiyo-e through Citizen Science." *Nihon kinsei bungaku kai International Symposium: Early Modern Graphic Narratives (kusazōshi)*, University of Cambridge (UK), 20/09/2025.
- Panelist: "Japan-Wissen offen(er) und nachhaltig(er) publizieren und archivieren?" 19. Deutschsprachiger Japanologentag, Frankfurt (DE), 22/08/2025, by invitation.
- "'Drawing from the Crowd': Eine Citizen-Science-Plattform zur geographischen Verortung von Ukiyo-e." 19. Deutschsprachiger Japanologentag, Goethe-Universität Frankfurt am Main (DE), 21/08/2025.
- "Reconstructing Japan's Scenic Past from Prints: Combining Citizen Science and AI-Methods for Authenticating Direct Observation in Ukiyo-e Landscapes," with Himanshu Panday. *ADHO Digital Humanities Conference 2025 (DH2025)*, Lisbon (PT), 16/07/2025.
- "From Print to Place: Creating an Integrative Geolocalization Workflow," with Drew Richardson. The Digital Orientalist Virtual Conference 2025, online, 31/05/2025.
- "Drawing from the Crowd: A Citizen Science Platform for Mapping Ukiyo-e Geography." Ritsumeikan ARC FY2024 Annual Report Meeting, Kyoto (JP), 21/02/2025.
- "Drawing from the Crowd." 9th Digital Humanities Research Meeting "Ukiyo-e, Citizen Science, and DH," Hibiya Library and Museum, Tokyo (JP), 21/01/2025, by invitation.
- "Citizen Science Webinar on Localizing Japanese Ukiyo-e Landscapes." The Nippon Foundation Scholars Association, Tokyo (JP), 20/01/2025.

2024

- "Viewed at a distance: geography in *ukiyo-e* prints." *Charting the European D-SEA: Digital Scholarship in East Asian Studies Conference*, Staatsbibliothek Berlin, 12/07/2024.

- "Hokusai's Eurasien: Vor- und Darstellungen von China, Indien und darüber hinaus." Zehnte Nachwuchstagung der Schweizerischen Asiengesellschaft, Basel, 08/05/2024.

2023 and earlier

- "Hokusai as an author-illustrator? / 戯作者兼絵師としての北斎." 28th International Ukiyo-e Society Autumn Conference, Yokohama (virtual, in Japanese), 25/11/2023.
- "Visual Vocabularies Within Poetic Microcosms." Asian Studies Conference Japan, Sophia University, Tokyo, 01–02/07/2023.
- With Sarah Amsler, "Zwischen Projekt- und globalem Thesaurus: 'Bilder der Schweiz Online'." 5. Schweizerischer Kongress für Kunstgeschichte, UZH, 23/06/2022.
- "Strategien zur Projektentwicklung in den Digital Humanities" and "Visuelle Daten im semantischen Raum (BSO)." Open Space des Arbeitskreises Digitale Kunstgeschichte (virtual), 29/01/2021.
- "Project Overview: Bilder der Schweiz Online." SARI/BSOxTime Machine Open Day (virtual), 08/12/2020.
- "Expectations and reality: developing an English/Japanese semantic web environment for the Late Hokusai research project." ADHO workshop, Towards Multilingualism in Digital Humanities, DH2019, Utrecht, 08/07/2019.
- "Collaborating in Late Hokusai ResearchSpace." Quid pro quo: linked data in art history research, 4th Swiss Congress of Art History, USI Mendrisio, 07/06/2019.
- "Progress report on the knowledge base of the Late Hokusai research project / 北斎後期研究プロジェクトの知識ベースに関する進捗報告." Digital Archive Industry-Academia-Government Forum, National Diet Library, Tokyo (in Japanese), 27/02/2019.
- "Challenges of building a multilingual web resource on Hokusai / 北斎に関する多言語データリソースの構築にあたっての課題." 29th EAJRS Conference, Vytautas Magnus University, Kaunas, 11/09/2018.
- "Building the arguments around the production of Katsushika Hokusai's single sheet impressions." Data Science for Digital Art History, KDD SIGG, London (UK), 20/08/2018.
- "Visualising Prehistory." 2nd Conference of the European Association for Asian Art and Archaeology (EAAAA), UZH, 25/08/2017.
- "Late Hokusai: Using Knowledge Representation for Community Collaboration." Symposium: Building Cultural Heritage Knowledge, The British Museum, London, 27–29/07/2017.
- "ResearchSpace and the Semantic Web." Late Hokusai Research Forum, Ritsumeikan University, Kyoto (JP), 20/11/2016; Gakushuin University, Tokyo, 25/11/2016.
- "Digitally Supported Visualisations of Japanese Archaeology at the British Museum." EU-Japan Research Workshop, UZH, 05/11/2016.
- "Challenges of Digitizing William Gowland at the British Museum." Symposium: Japanese Cultural Assets and Digitalization, CEEJA Colmar, 29/03/2016.
- "William Kuprecht — Understanding the Foreign(er): A Swiss textile printing expert in Kyoto 1902–1909." Kansai University EU-Japan Workshop, Osaka, 20/09/2014.
- "Capturing the Moment Over Three Hundred Years: The Rieder Collection of Japanese Woodblock Prints" / "The Burgdorf Völkerkunde Museum and the KGOA Project." Symposium 'Moving Art between East Asia and the West', UZH, 07–08/03/2013.